FUNCTIONAL SPECIFICATION DOCUMENT (FSD)

Car Rental Request Automation

1. Introduction

Project Title: Car Rental Request Automation

Platform: ServiceNow

Main ServiceNow Components: Service Catalog and Workflow

Document Purpose: This Functional Specification Document describes the functional requirements, process flow, roles, data captured, approvals, fulfillment activities, notifications, and expected behavior of the Car Rental Request Automation solution.

2. Project Overview

2.1 Purpose

The purpose of this project is to automate the car rental request process in ServiceNow. Employees can submit a request through a Service Catalog item, provide the required rental details, and send the request through an automated approval and fulfillment workflow.

2.2 Objectives

- Provide a centralized method for submitting car rental requests.
- Capture all required rental information in a standard format.
- Automatically route requests for approval.
- Create fulfillment tasks after approval.
- Notify users about important request status changes.
- Provide visibility and tracking throughout the request lifecycle.

2.3 Key Features

- Car Rental Request catalog item.
- Mandatory field validation.
- Automated approval workflow.
- Approval and rejection handling.
- Automatic fulfillment task creation.
- Task assignment to the responsible team.
- Requester notifications.
- Request status tracking and audit history.

3. Functional Requirements

FR-01: Request Submission

The system shall allow an authorized requester to open the Car Rental Request catalog item and submit a new rental request.

FR-02: Request Information

The catalog item shall collect required information such as requester, rental date, pickup location, return date, return location, vehicle type, purpose, and other business-required details.

FR-03: Validation

The system shall validate mandatory fields before allowing the request to be submitted.

FR-04: Request Creation

On submission, ServiceNow shall create the required request/requested-item records and initiate the configured workflow.

FR-05: Approval

The workflow shall route the request to the designated approver for review.

FR-06: Approval Decision

If approved, the workflow shall continue to fulfillment. If rejected, the request shall follow the rejection path and the requester shall be notified.

FR-07: Fulfillment

For an approved request, the workflow shall create a fulfillment task and assign it to the responsible rental/support team.

FR-08: Completion

After fulfillment is completed, the request shall be updated to the appropriate completed/closed state.

FR-09: Notifications

The system shall send notifications for relevant events such as submission, approval, rejection, and completion.

FR-10: Tracking

The requester and authorized users shall be able to track the request status and view relevant request information.

4. System Architecture

4.1 ServiceNow Architecture

The solution is implemented inside the ServiceNow platform. The Service Catalog provides the user-facing request form. The submitted catalog request generates ServiceNow request records. Workflow controls the business process, including approval, decision handling, task creation, notifications, and completion.

4.2 Main Components

- Service Catalog Item – Car Rental Request.
- Catalog Variables – Capture rental and requester information.
- Workflow – Automates the request lifecycle.
- Approval Activity – Routes the request to an authorized approver.
- Task Activity – Creates work for the responsible fulfillment team.
- Notification – Communicates important status changes.
- Request/RITM and Task Records – Maintain tracking and history.

5. Service Catalog Specification

5.1 Catalog Item

Name: Car Rental Request

Purpose: Provides employees with a standard form to request a rental vehicle.

5.2 Suggested Catalog Variables

- Requested For – Employee for whom the rental is required.
- Rental Start Date – Date on which the rental begins.
- Rental End Date – Date on which the rental ends.
- Pickup Location – Location where the vehicle is required.
- Return Location – Location where the vehicle will be returned.
- Vehicle Type – Required vehicle category.
- Rental Purpose – Business purpose or reason for the rental.
- Additional Requirements – Optional comments or special requirements.

5.3 Validation Rules

- Mandatory fields must be completed before submission.
- Rental end date should not be earlier than the rental start date.
- Date and location information should follow the configured business rules.
- Only permitted vehicle types should be selectable.

6. Workflow Specification

6.1 Workflow Flow

Request Submission → Workflow Trigger → Approval → Decision → Fulfillment Task → Task Completion → Request Completion → Notification

6.2 Approval Path

After the request is submitted, the workflow sends an approval request to the configured approver. The approver reviews the rental details and either approves or rejects the request.

6.3 Rejection Path

If the approver rejects the request, the workflow updates the request to the appropriate rejected state and sends a rejection notification to the requester.

6.4 Fulfillment Path

If approved, the workflow creates a fulfillment task for the responsible team. The team processes the rental requirement and completes the task. The workflow then moves the request toward completion.

6.5 Completion

When fulfillment is complete, ServiceNow updates the request status and sends a completion notification to the requester.

7. Roles and Responsibilities

- Requester – Enters accurate rental information and submits the request.
- Approver – Reviews the request and approves or rejects it.
- Fulfillment/Rental Team – Processes approved requests and completes assigned tasks.
- ServiceNow Administrator – Configures the catalog item, workflow, notifications, access, and maintenance.

8. Notifications

- Request submitted – Confirms that the request was received.
- Approval required – Alerts the approver that action is required.
- Request approved – Informs the requester that the request has been approved.
- Request rejected – Informs the requester that the request was rejected.
- Fulfillment/completion – Informs the requester when processing is completed.

9. Non-Functional Requirements

- Usability – The catalog form should be simple and easy to understand.
- Availability – The solution should be available whenever the ServiceNow instance is available.
- Security – Only authorized users should access request and approval information.
- Auditability – Request, approval, and task activities should be traceable through ServiceNow records and history.
- Maintainability – Workflow and catalog configuration should be structured so that future changes can be managed easily.

10. Error and Exception Handling

- Missing mandatory information should prevent request submission.
- Invalid date combinations should be rejected according to configured validation rules.
- Rejected approvals should follow the defined rejection path.
- Workflow or task exceptions should be monitored by the ServiceNow administrator.
- Users should receive appropriate status information when processing cannot continue normally.

11. Testing Requirements

- Verify successful catalog request submission.
- Verify mandatory field validation.

- Verify workflow initiation.
- Verify approval notification and approval decision.
- Verify rejection path and requester notification.
- Verify fulfillment task creation and assignment.
- Verify task completion and request closure.
- Verify requester notifications at each configured stage.
- Verify request status and history tracking.

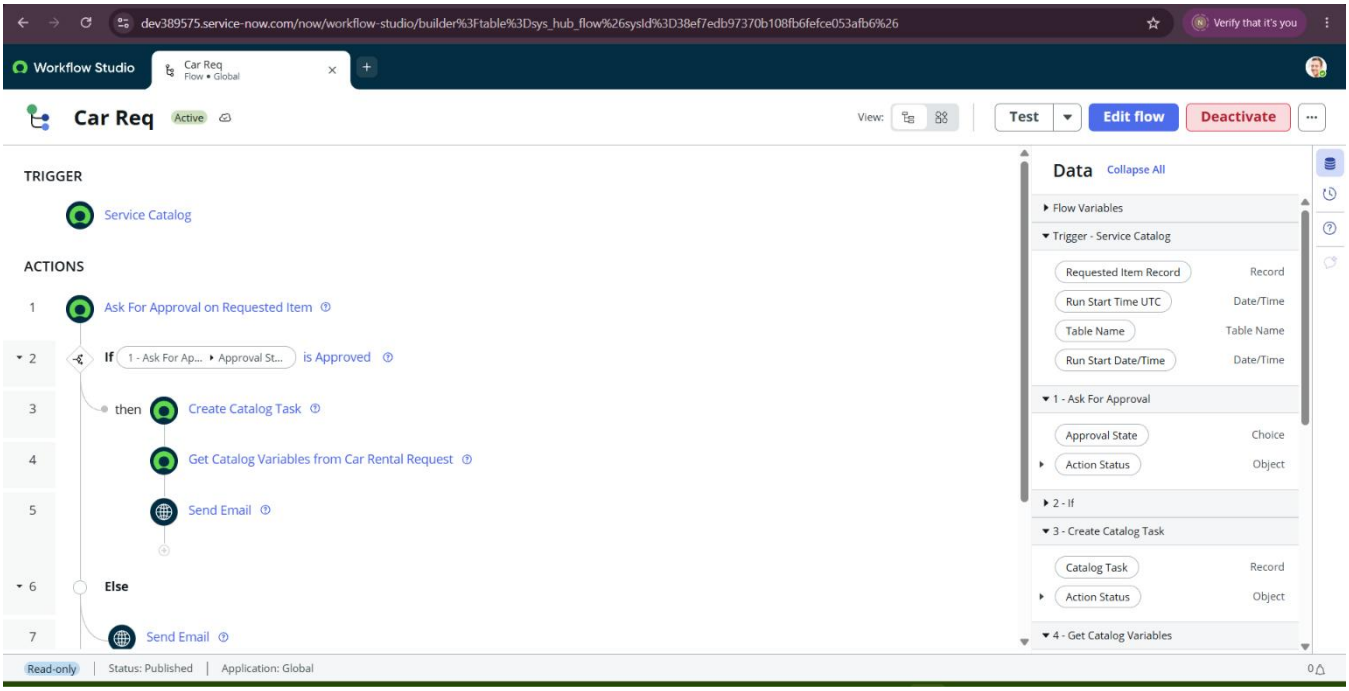
12. Assumptions and Dependencies

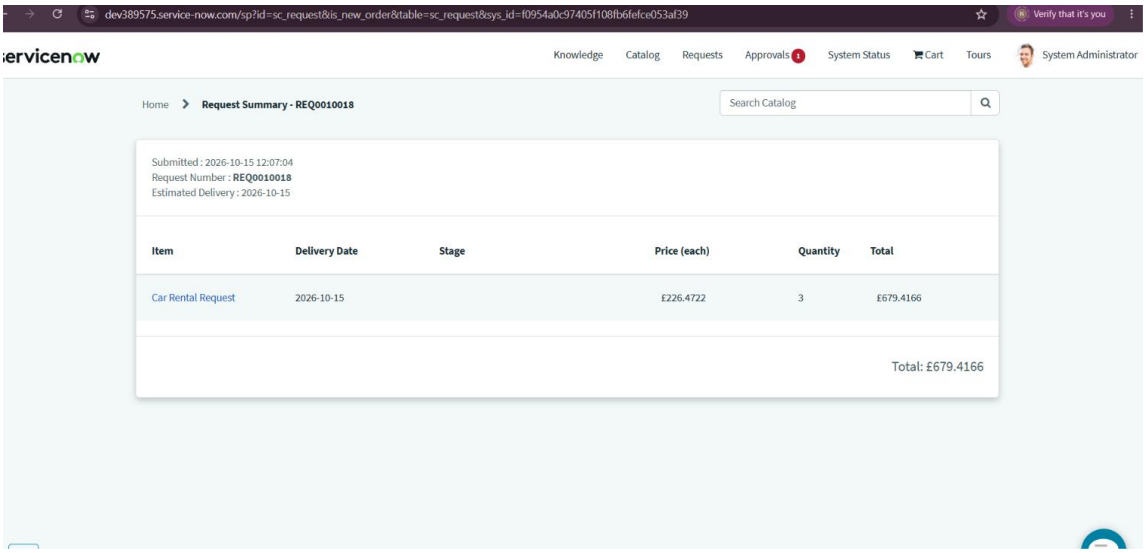
- The ServiceNow instance and required Service Catalog/Workflow functionality are available.
- Approvers and fulfillment groups are configured in ServiceNow.
- Business rules for rental dates, vehicle types, and approvals are defined by the organization.
- Notification/email functionality is available in the ServiceNow environment.

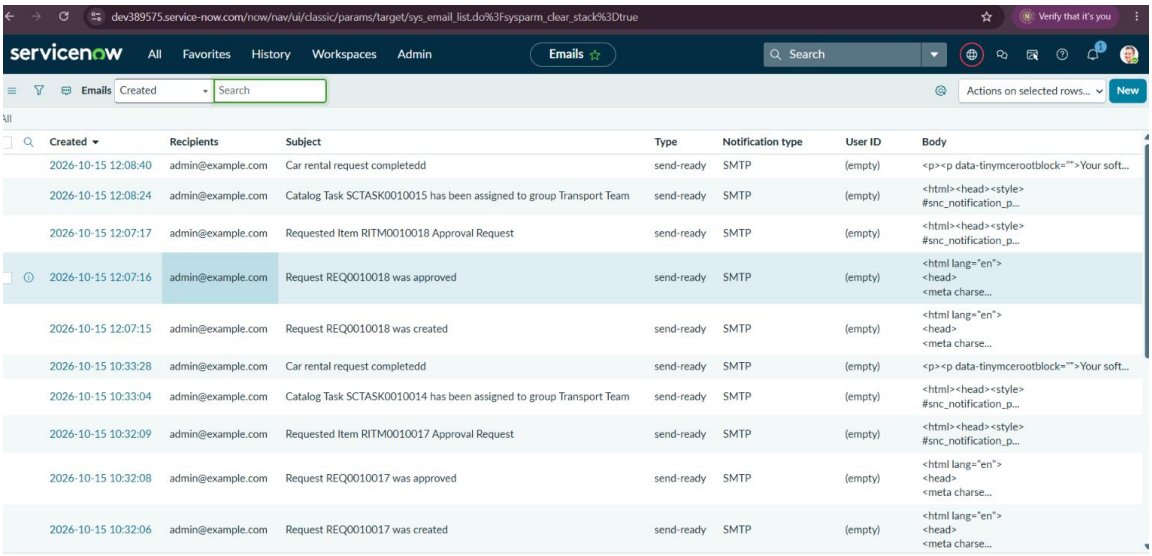
13. Future Enhancements

- Integrate with an external fleet or car rental system.
- Automatically check vehicle availability.
- Add rental cost estimation and budget approval.
- Add automated reminders for pending approvals.
- Add dashboards for request volume, approval time, and fulfillment performance.
- Add SLA-based monitoring for delayed fulfillment.

14. Results




dev389575.service-now.com/sp?id=sc_request&is_new_order&table=sc_request&sys_id=f0954a0c97405f108fb6fefce053af39
Verify that it's you
servicenow
Knowledge
Catalog
Requests
Approvals 1
System Status
Cart
Tours
System Administrator
Home
Request Summary - REQ0010018
Search Catalog
Submitted : 2026-10-15 12:07:04
Request Number : REQ0010018
Estimated Delivery : 2026-10-15
Item
Delivery Date
Stage
Price (each)
Quantity
Total
Car Rental Request
2026-10-15
£226.4722
3
£679.4166
Total: £679.4166



15. Appendix

https://github.com/shreee8/Car-Rental-Request-Automation

Servicenow Instance: https://dev389575.service-now.com/sp

Source Code: ServiceNow scripts are maintained in the configured Business Rule and portal widgets.